STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-6420
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA GREG LONDON SHERIFF	DATE ISSUED **08/13/07**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL: K-9 UNIT	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT K-9 CARE AND EQUIPMENT	CROSS REFERENCE G-3320 UTILITY/JAIL UNIFORM G-4200 PURCHASES			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for the kenneling and care of Sheriff's Office canines and the maintenance of K-9 Unit equipment.

II. Policy:

Handlers shall be responsible for ensuring their assigned K-9s receive regular veterinary care, exercise and maintenance. The cost of all care and maintenance (e.g. food, supplements, medication, veterinary care, etc.) shall be the responsibility of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office. K-9 handlers shall be responsible for the maintenance of all assigned K-9 Unit equipment including K-9 patrol units.

III. Procedure:

A. Kenneling of K-9s:

1. Each K-9 handler shall be issued an enclosed kennel to ensure the safe/secure kenneling of his or her assigned K-9 inside the handler's residence.

2. Each K-9 handler shall also be issued an appropriate outdoor kennel to ensure the safe and secure kenneling of his or her assigned K-9 on the handler's property.

3. If a handler is on extended leave, the handler shall coordinate with the K-9 Unit Commander for kenneling, if needed. The K-9 may be allowed to remain at the handler's residence if the handler can demonstrate full control over the K-9 during the entire period of absence.

4. K-9 handlers shall immediately notify the K-9 Unit Commander of any changes that would affect the kenneling of their K-9 (e.g. change of residence, marriage, etc.).

5. The K-9 Unit Commander may make periodic inspections of the K-9 handler's residence and K-9 kenneling arrangements to ensure adequate care and safety.

B. Routine Care of K-9s: The K-9 handler is responsible for the care, cleaning, handling, and daily training of his or her assigned K-9.

1. K-9 handlers are personally responsible for the daily care and feeding to include:

a) Maintenance and cleaning of the kennel and area where the canine is housed.

b) Provision of food, water and general diet maintenance as prescribed by an authorized veterinarian.

c) Grooming on a daily basis or more often as required by weather or work conditions

d) Daily exercise.

2. To allow for required maintenance of the K-9 and equipment, thirty (30) minutes of each handler's shift shall be dedicated for this purpose.

a) The K-9 team shall be available for calls during this time.

b) Should a call interfere with this time, maintenance shall be resumed upon completion of the assignment.

c) Only in emergencies shall maintenance be allowed after a shift and overtime accrued (e.g. K-9 is extremely dirty or has been exposed to health risks).

3. Each K-9 handler shall be authorized thirty (30) minutes of overtime on any day not scheduled to work to provide daily maintenance for his or her assigned K-9.

C. Veterinary Care for K-9s: K-9s shall only be administered to by Sheriff's Office approved veterinarians, except in the case of emergency.

1. Each K-9 shall receive an annual physical including all vaccinations and a heartworm check.

2. Any time a K-9 must visit a veterinarian, except in an emergency, the K-9 Unit Commander shall be notified in advance as to the nature of the visit. A report of the services rendered by the veterinarian shall be forwarded to the K-9 Unit Commander by the K-9 handler after the visit.

3. K-9 handlers shall notify the K-9 Unit Commander of any emergency care required for an assigned K-9 or of any condition that may affect a K-9's ability to perform assigned duties.

4. The K-9 Unit Commander shall maintain all veterinary records for each K-9.

D. K-9 Unit Equipment: The K-9 Unit Commander shall be responsible for the inventory and procurement of K-9 Unit equipment. Each K-9 handler shall be responsible for the care and maintenance of assigned equipment.

1. The K-9 Unit Commander shall keep an inventory of all K-9 Unit equipment and shall conduct periodic inspections to ensure proper condition.

2. All equipment shall be approved by the K-9 Unit Commander prior to use.

3. The K-9 Unit Commander shall determine if issued equipment is no longer suitable for use and shall be responsible for replacement.

4. If the handler is required or authorized to purchase an item of equipment or item for his or her K-9's maintenance, the handler shall submit the request for reimbursement to the K-9 Unit Commander. The K-9 Unit Commander shall review the request prior to submitting it according to established procedure (see G-4200 Purchases).

5. K-9 handlers shall be responsible for reporting any damage to K-9 Unit equipment to the K-9 Unit Commander as soon as possible.

E. K-9 Handler Uniform:

1. The standard uniform for the K-9 handler shall be the Sheriff's Office utility uniform (see G-3320 Utility/Jail Uniform) with the following modifications:

a) The uniform shirt shall have "K-9 Unit" embroidered above the handler's name above the right breast pocket. "K-9 Unit" shall also be embroidered in two (2) inch letters directly below "Sheriff" on the back of the shirt.

b) The K-9 Unit Commander may approve other uniform modifications and/or equipment additions, as necessary.

2. Undercover or covert operations may necessitate the wearing of civilian clothing or utilization of an undercover vehicle. This shall be approved on a case by case basis by the K-9 Unit Commander.

F. Ownership of K-9s:

1. Upon purchase of any canine for the Sheriff's Office K-9 Unit, the animal shall become the property of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office.

2. If the K-9 is a registered purebred animal, registration papers shall be kept with all medical records by the K-9 Unit Commander.

3. Sheriff's Office K-9s shall not knowingly be used for breeding without the written permission of the Sheriff. Sheriff's Office K-9s shall not be used for participation in shows, field trials, exhibitions or other demonstrations without permission from the K-9 Unit Commander.

4. When a K-9 is no longer capable of performing assigned duties as required, it shall be retired from duty.

a) Every attempt shall be made to transfer ownership of a retired K-9 to the handler, if he or she desires, or to another suitable owner.

b) A Release form shall be completed and signed by any party taking ownership of a retired K-9. Parties taking ownership of a retired K-9 accept all responsibility for the animal.

c) Certain stipulations regarding the transfer of ownership of a retired K-9 may need to be followed if the K-9 was purchased with funds other than those provided by Sarpy County. The K-9 Unit Commander shall be responsible for ensuring adherence to any such stipulations.